

# Rooted in Resilience

A Monumental Public Artwork by Hamza AbuAyyash



Hamza AbuAyyash



Location: Ghent, Belgium

Size: 500 m<sup>2</sup> artwork

Institutional Partner: Viernulvier, Ghent



## Project Overview

**Project Name:** Rooted in Resilience

**Location:** Viernulvier, Ghent, Belgium

**Dimensions:** 500m<sup>2</sup> (18m x 28m)

**Duration:** February - August 2025

**Themes:** Solidarity, resistance, resilience, cultural memory

**Main Elements:** Arabic calligraphy, poppy motifs, Ghassan Zaqtan's poem By Force of Habit

**Objective:** To use public art as a tool for political discourse, memory, and engagement

### Project Description: Rooted in Resilience

Rooted in Resilience is a large-scale public art project by Hamza AbuAyyash, commissioned by Viernulvier in Ghent. It transforms the center's facade into a powerful statement of solidarity with Palestine, using bold imagery and symbolism to engage themes of resistance, identity, and cultural endurance.

Blending visual storytelling and activism, the project invites public reflection on colonialism and displacement. Accompanied by discussions and a limited merch collection, it underscores art's role in advocacy and political consciousness, asserting its power as a medium for justice and solidarity.

### Artist Bio:

**Name:** Hamza Abu Ayash

**Background:** Palestinian artist and designer based in Jordan

**Education:** Master's in Autonomous Design, KASK, University College Ghent

**Work Themes:** Public art, resistance, identity, visual storytelling

Hamza AbuAyyash is a Palestinian artist and designer exploring art, politics, and public space. A graduate of KASK, Ghent, his work addresses resistance, identity, and collective memory through public art, illustration, and set design.

His last project Rooted in Resilience, commissioned by Viernulvier, transforms the center's facade into a statement of solidarity with Palestine. Currently based in Amman, he is pursuing his PhD, Unveiling Signification, examining visual culture's performative aspects, continuing his commitment to art as advocacy.

# Concept and Symbolism

The artwork incorporates calligraphy and visual metaphors to address displacement and war. The poem *By Force of Habit* by the great Palestinian poet Ghassan Zaqtan plays a central role, reflecting themes of occupation, the normalization of violence, and collective memory.

The symbolism is centered on three key elements:

**Poppies:** Represent resilience and remembrance.

**Arabic calligraffiti:** Represents deep ties to heritage and cultural continuity.

**Public intervention:** Consists of turning the construction site (scaffolding) into a public political statement.

## By force of habit Ghassan Zaqtan

The soldier that the squad left in the garden,  
the squad that the border guards left at the checkpoint,  
the checkpoint that the occupation left at the crossing,  
the occupation that the politician left in our lives,  
the politician who was a soldier in the occupation,  
the Merkava that the army left at the school,  
the army that the war left in the city,  
the war which the general left in the bedroom,  
the general whom the peace left in our sleep,  
the peace that was driving the Merkava,  
still snipe at our heads without orders,  
just so,  
by force of habit.

Translated by Robin Moger

This poem was part of the book that was published by Seagull  
you can buy it at The Seagull Books Store

"Rooted in Resilience is an act of visual resistance. It stands as a testimony to the endurance of displaced communities and a reminder that memory is stronger than erasure."

Hamza AbuAyyash

## Across the city





# Media coverage

VIERNULVIER installs Ghent's largest artwork 'Rooted in Resilience' on facade De Vooruit

VIERNULVIER is installing a new artwork by Palestinian artist Hamza Abu Ayyash on the facade of De Vooruit. The work, titled "Rooted in Resilience," will cover our scaffolding during the building's renovation period, and will remain hanging until the end of August 2025.

Covering an area of 500 square meters (18 meters high and 28 meters wide), the artwork is a true feat to install.

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Het kunstwerk is gebaseerd op een gedicht, er zijn onder meer klagen te zien.  
Foto: VIERNULVIER

### Palestijns kunstwerk siert komende maanden Vooruit-gebouw Gent: "Teken van solidariteit"

Aan het Vooruit-gebouw in Gent is een enorm groot canvas geïnstalleerd met een kunstwerk van de Palestijnse kunstenaar Hamza Abu Ayyash. De voorgevel staat in de stellingen voor renovatiewerken. Het werk blijft tot het einde van de zomer hangen.

## VIERNULVIER INSTALLS GHENT'S LARGEST ARTWORK 'ROOTED IN RESILIENCE' ON FACADE DE VOORUIT

VIERNULVIER is installing a new artwork by Palestinian artist Hamza Abu Ayyash on the facade of De Vooruit. The work, titled "Rooted in Resilience," will cover our scaffolding during the building's renovation period, and will remain hanging until the end of August 2025.

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## “Blijf niet onverschillig bij het leed”: enorm kunstwerk midden in Gent wil solidariteit met Palestijnen tonen



Maandag begon de operatie om het enorme kunstwerk op te hangen. Op deze foto ontbreekt nog een derde deel. — © fvv

GENT - Aan de gevel van de Vooruit hangt sinds maandag een gigantisch kunstwerk van 500 vierkante meter. Daarmee wil kunstencentrum Viernulvier solidariteit tonen met het Palestijnse volk.

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### “Rooted in Resilience”: kunstwerk op gevel van Vooruit vraagt aandacht voor situatie in Gaza

De Vooruit staat in de stellingen, en die kans laat kunstencentrum Viernulvier niet onbenut. Nog tot eind augustus van de Palestijnse kunstenaar Hamza Abu Ayyash.

## VIERNULVIER, GENT INSTALLEERT GIGANTISCH KUNSTWERK 'ROOTED IN RESILIENCE'

Geschreven door - [Johan Meuris](#) -



ViernulVier, Gent installeert gigantisch kunstwerk 'Rooted in Resilience'

ViernulVier, Gent installeert gigantisch kunstwerk 'Rooted in Resilience' van Kunstenaar Hamza Abu Ayyash op voorgevel De Vooruit. Een canvas voor solidariteit en engagement.

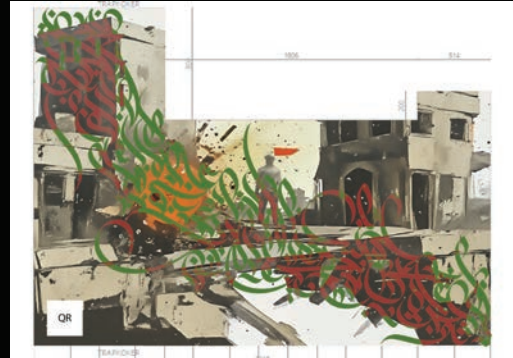
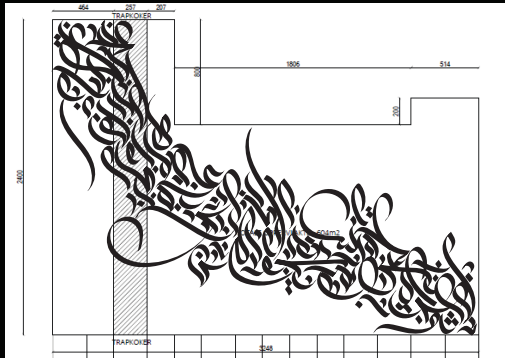
VIERNULVIER installeert een nieuw (en gigantisch) kunstwerk van de Palestijnse kunstenaar Hamza Abu Ayyash aan de voorgevel van De Vooruit. Het werk, getiteld 'Rooted in Resilience', zal onze stelling bekleden tijdens de renovatieperiode van het gebouw. en blijft hangen tot eind augustus 2025.

Meer info [www.viernulvier.gent](http://www.viernulvier.gent)



## Sketches and process

## initial sketch



## 2nd Version



## Final design



Are you an institution, museum, or cultural organization interested in commissioning impactful public art projects?

Hamza Abu Ayash specializes in site-specific installations, blending visual storytelling with social and political themes. Whether for urban interventions, cultural events, or large-scale murals, his work brings critical discourse into public spaces.

For inquiries about potential collaborations or commissions

Contact:

Hamza AbuAyyash

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X: [@7mz](https://twitter.com/7mz) | Facebook: Hamza AbuAyyash

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